SAMUEL A. EDET, PhD

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Applied economist with a PhD in Economics and over five years of experience conducting and leading empirical research at the International Finance Corporation (IFC), World Bank Group. Expertise in econometrics, causal inference, financial economics, innovation, and firm-level analysis, with extensive experience developing analytical methodologies, integrating large-scale datasets, and evaluating complex economic relationships. Published researcher with a strong quantitative foundation in applied mathematics, experience managing research projects and supervising analytical teams, and a track record of communicating rigorous economic findings to academics, policymakers, and senior institutional stakeholders.

EDUCATION

PhD, Applied Economics — KU Leuven, Belgium (2017–2022)
Joint PhD: KU Leuven (Belgium) + IMT School for Advanced Studies (Italy)

- *Thesis: Essays on Innovation Networks (cited in The Economist)*

MSc, Mathematical Sciences — University of Cape Town, South Africa (2016–2017) | *Distinction*

- *Thesis: Recurrent Neural Networks in Forecasting S&P 500 Index (Nominated for 2017 Thomson Reuters Excellence Award)*

BSc, Mathematics — University of Ibadan, Nigeria (2010–2014) | *First Class Honours (CGPA:4.6/5)*

- *University Scholar Award.*

CERTIFICATIONS

- CFA Level III Candidate (Passed Level II in 2025) | CFA Institute

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Economist (Private Market Research) — World Bank Group / IFC-DEC Private Market Research Department | Washington, DC (January 2021–Present) | *Associate Economist (1.5years) -> Economist (4years).*

- **Macro/Micro to markets and policy translation.** Designed, maintained, and built econometric, machine learning, causal inference, network science, scenario, and sensitivity frameworks that translate macroeconomic and microeconomic drivers — rates, FX, growth, inflation, and fiscal dynamics — into capital-need and productivity of firms, macro-spillovers, country-sectoral risk and opportunities for senior stakeholders. Analytical products include:
  - **World Bank Group Reports.** Drafting and co-leading chapters in reports. Sample reports include Finance and business dynamics (forthcoming); Innovation in green technologies (2025); Digital opportunities in African business (2024); Building Green: Sustainable Construction in Emerging Markets (2023). Led drafting and

analysis of sectoral deep dives on the Digital Financial Service sector for Gambia's private sector diagnostics.

- **Operational Tools.** Developed "Sector scan" tool for sector-level investment thesis to inform World Bank Group's investment thesis in EM countries. Managed the development of "Innovation Economy Value Chain Explorer" – a tool that identifies innovative firms based on patent activities.
- **Project and team leadership.** Managed the analytical work, tool development, and hiring process of research assistants and consultants. Coordinate and co-lead the drafting of report chapters, working papers, and articles. Review and provide feedback on institutional reports on subject matter of innovation and finance.
- **External engagement.** Engaged with academics, policymakers, and industry colleagues across the World Bank Group's global network to challenge and refine internal views on macro and micro financial developments in emerging and frontier markets**.**

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

- Edet et al. (2027). *A Sparse-Low Rank Interpolation Framework for Evaluating Matrix Filtering and Portfolio Allocation*. (forthcoming)
- Edet (2026). *Venture Capital, Scale, and the Reorientation of Innovation: Firm-Level Evidence from 71 Countries*. Available at SSRN: https://ssrn.com/abstract=7645558 or http://dx.doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.7645558
- Edet et al. (2026). *Innovation partnerships for development along green value chains* (CEP Discussion Paper No. 2223). **Centre for Economic Performance, London School of Economics and Political Science.**
- Edet et al. (2025). *Predicting the technological complexity of global cities based on unsupervised and supervised machine learning methods*. **Journal of Economic Behavior & Organization**.
- Edet et al. 2024. "The Hurdles and High Costs of Digital Adoption in Africa." IFC Economics. LinkedIn. https://www.linkedin.com/pulse/hurdles-high-costs-digital-adoption-africa-ifc-economics-qaorc/.
- Edet et al. (2021). *Global Cities in International Networks of Innovators*. **Advances in Complex Systems**.
- Edet (2017). Recurrent Neural Networks in Forecasting S&P 500 Index. **Available at SSRN:** https://ssrn.com/abstract=3001046 or http://dx.doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.3001046

AWARDS & FELLOWSHIP

World Bank Group Africa Fellowship (2021) | Frontier Research Fellowship (2021) | Erasmus Mobility Consortium Funding (2018,2020) |Alfred P. Sloan Young Scholar Funding (2019) | KU Leuven Fully Funded PhD Scholarship (2017) |Finalist Thomson Reuters Excellence Award (2017) |AIMS South Africa Fully Funded MSc Scholarship (2016) | Deans Roll of Honor (2012-2014).